FORECASTING PROJECT

# Lenin and Stalin on Russian TV

## Forecasting references to Soviet leaders in television discourse

Mention counts and archive records with at least one mention

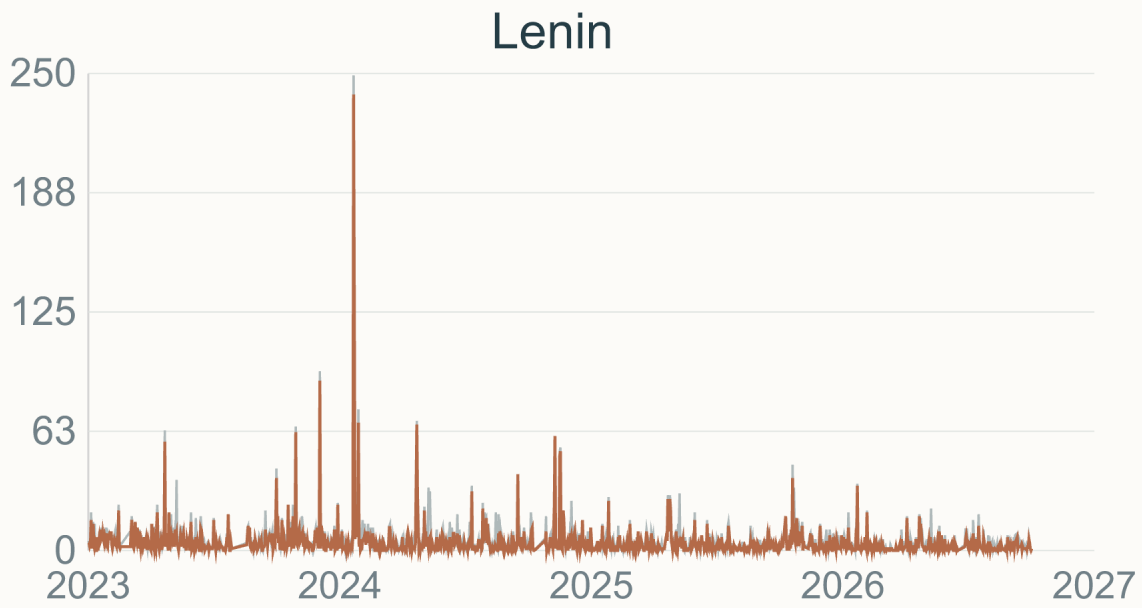
3 October – 2 November 2026

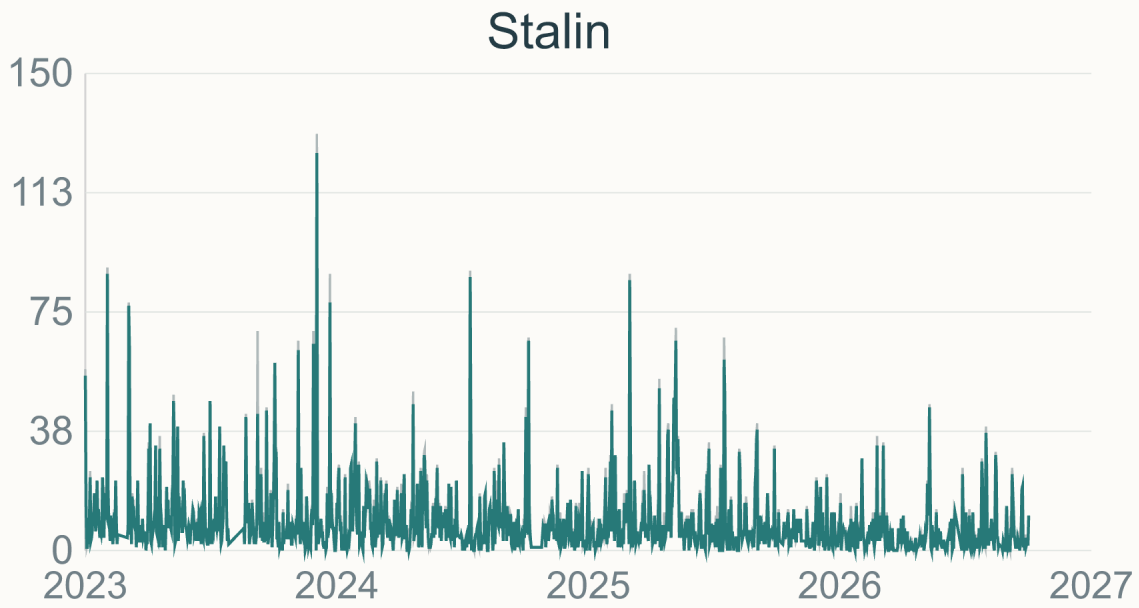
Sofya Kupcha, Ksenia Paltseva

# Historical mention counts

Four channels, January 2023 – 2 October 2026. Daily mention counts

5,334 of 5,484 channel-days complete. Incomplete dates omitted, observed points joined.




Grey: all surname matches before cleaning

Colour: historical-figure contexts after cleaning

# Observations and predictive intervals

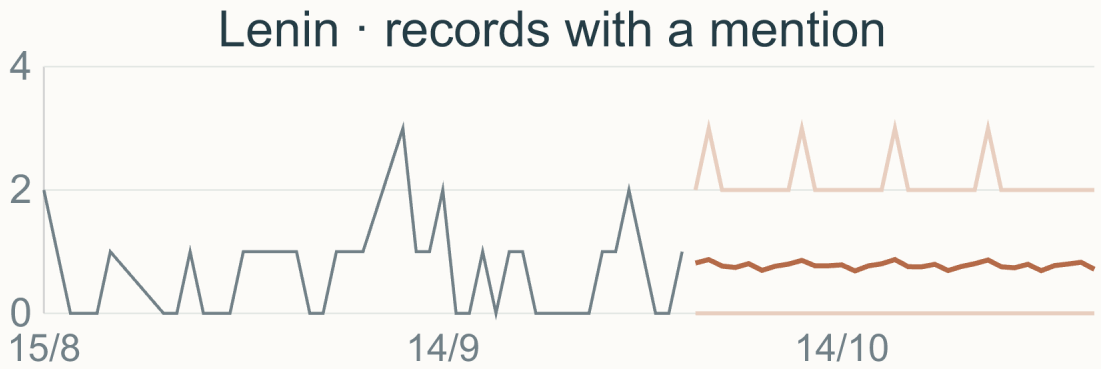
Russia 24. Both forecast targets for Lenin and Stalin, model M3

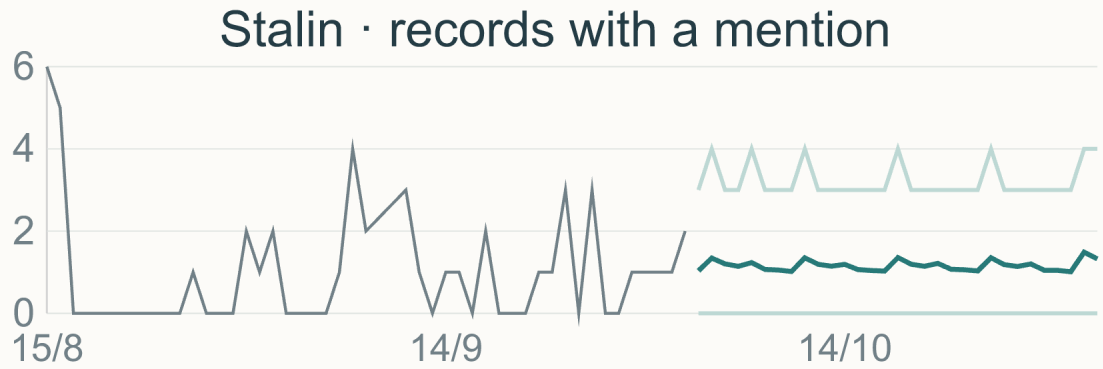
Grey: observations. Colour: predictive mean. Pale lines: 80% interval bounds.









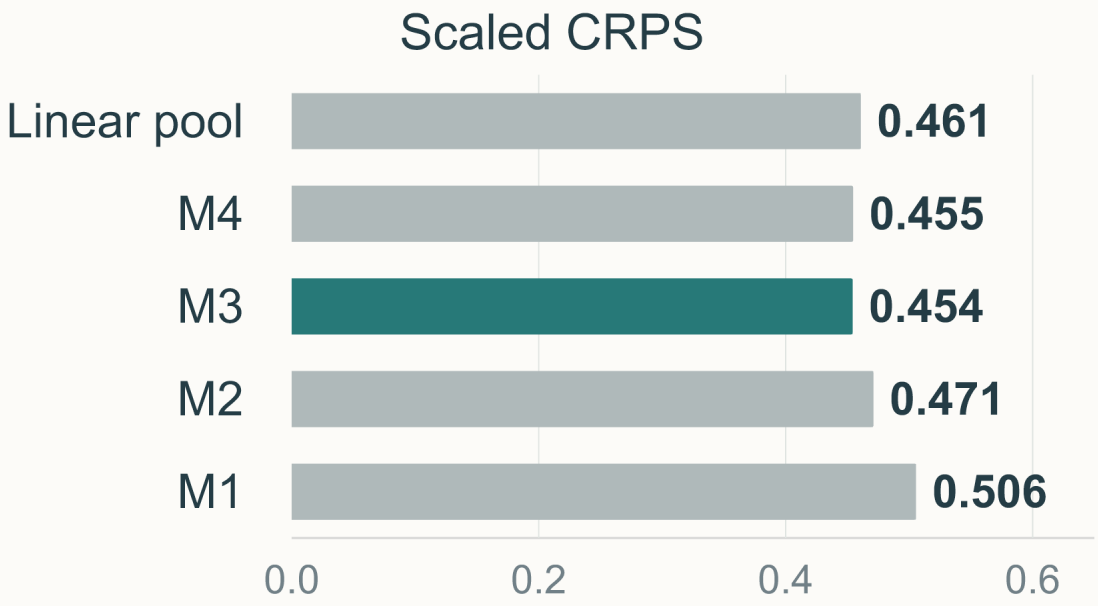



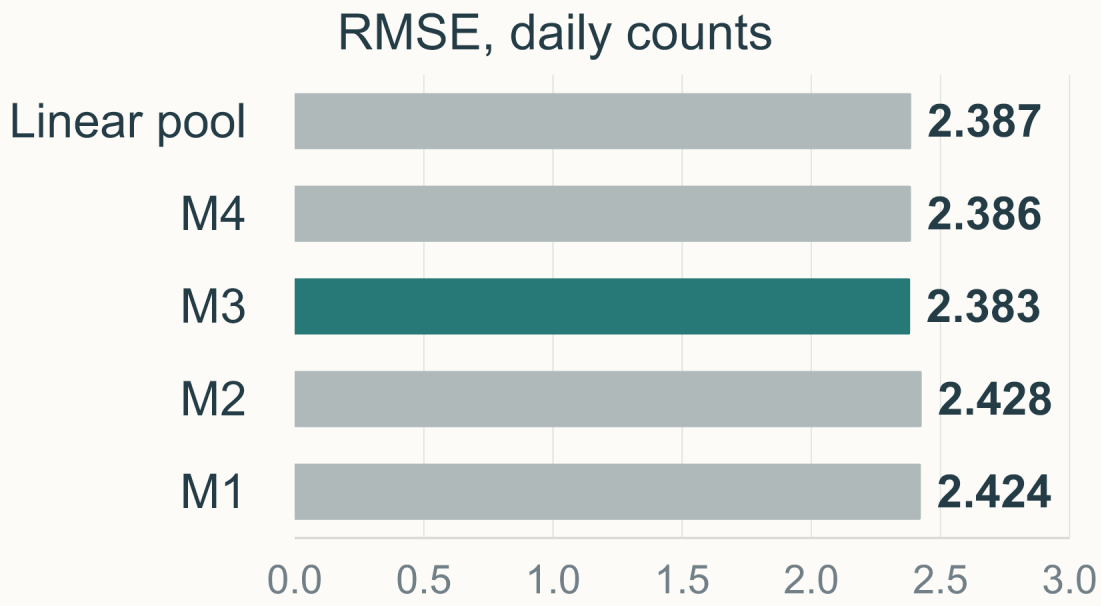

Forecast: 3 October – 2 November 2026. Information set fixed at 2 October.

# Out-of-sample forecast evaluation

Test: January 2025 – September 2026, 21 months. Lower scores are better.

Count hierarchy: $p(N) \times p(B \mid N) \times p(C \mid B)$, $C = B + E$



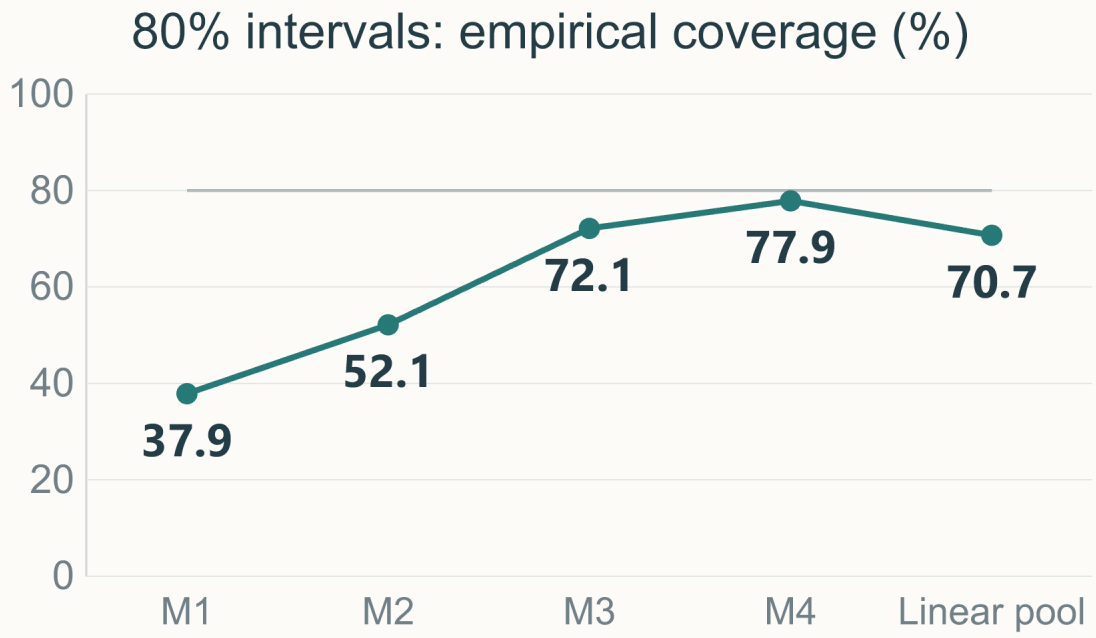



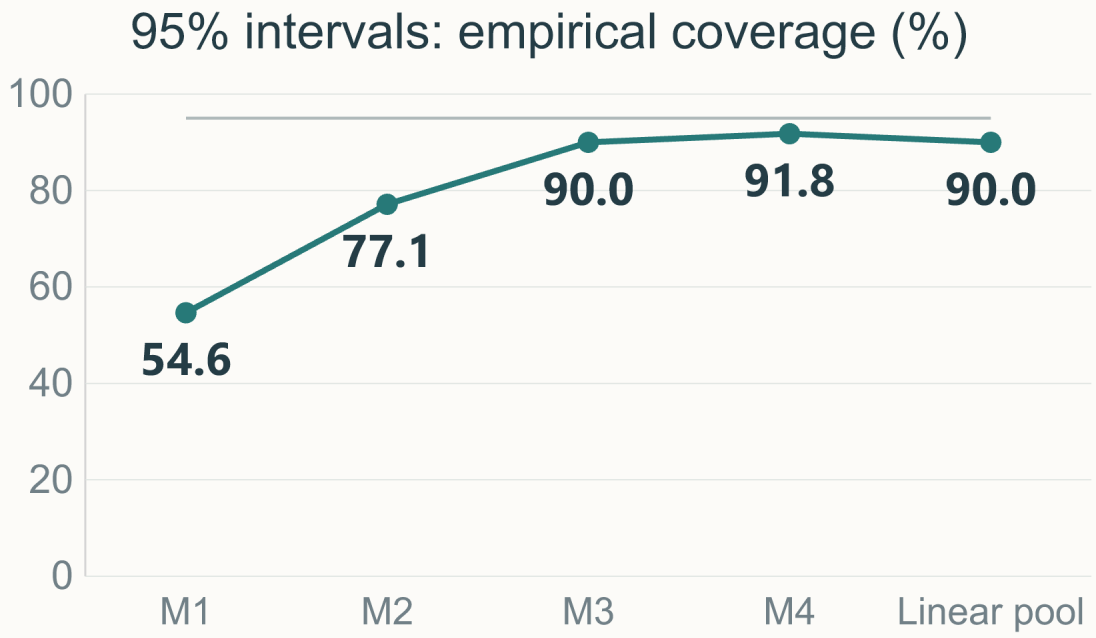

M1: baseline M2: overdispersion M3: calendar and trend M4: dynamic level

M3 reduces scaled CRPS by 10.2% and RMSE by 1.7% relative to M1.

# Predictive interval coverage for monthly totals

Out-of-sample test: 280 complete monthly totals. Higher lines indicate greater coverage.




Grey: nominal coverage of 80% and 95%. Green: empirical coverage.

M3 intervals are too narrow. M4 coverage is closer to the nominal level.